

GovWin
from Deltek

RedTeam
CONSULTING

WEBINAR SERIES

Government Bid Success Series



Part 1: Keys to Building an Opportunity Pipeline

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About Us

Red Team Consulting, LLC (Red Team) is a strategic growth consultancy that helps companies scale in the government contracting market. Over our 20+ years, we've helped thousands of companies achieve their growth targets with our full lifecycle business development, capture, proposal development, and training services. With our support, our clients continue to beat their fiercest competitors, diversify their portfolio of customers, and achieve their financial goals.



Established in March 2004.



Headquartered in Northern Virginia with virtual offices across the country.



Thousands of government contracts secured.
Billions in Federal revenue generated.



1,000+ clients ranging from small businesses to large systems integrators and consulting firms across many industries.



Core services: Growth Strategy, Capture Strategy, Proposal Development, and Training.



Clients across the US and overseas.

Tris Carpenter

- Red Team General Manager, Strategic Growth
- Over 30+ years of Growth Advisory and Business Development experience in the Public and Commercial sectors
- Involved in the award of over \$15 billion in Federal and DoD contracts
- Delivered business strategy, technology solutions to the Federal Government and Fortune 500 companies worldwide
- Mentored/trained BD and capture leads, project managers, and technical staff





Agenda

Keys to building an opportunity pipeline

1. Strategy
2. Building
3. Elaboration
4. Management
5. Implementation

Strategy

Pipeline strategy

Value as a strategic roadmap

- ✓ **Strategic road map:** Aligns potential opportunities with your company's growth objectives and core capabilities
- ✓ **Long-term approach:** Prioritizes building strategic partnerships and relationships versus just chasing individual bids
- ✓ **Relationship building:** Implements defined touchpoints, influence strategies, and relationship metrics
- ✓ **Teaming decisions:** Growing partnerships to expand your network and secure high-value opportunities through alliances



Focuses on high-value targets, building key relationships, and choosing strategic partners to drive sustainable growth



Pipeline strategy

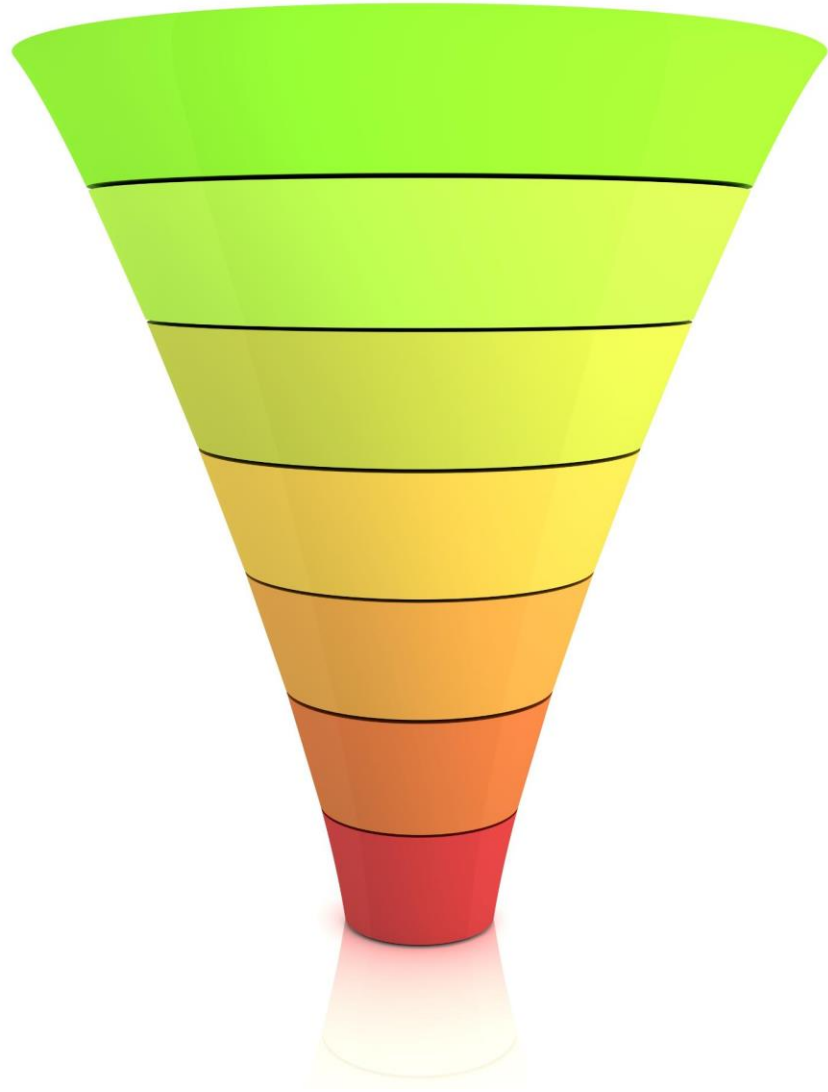
What is 10x growth?

- 💡 Pursue an ambitious yet attainable target (e.g., \$5M → \$50M over 3–5 years) with annual milestones and capability investment needs
- 💡 Align teams around specific milestones, process improvements, and resource investments with accountability metrics
- 💡 Leverage standardized opportunity identification methods, stage-gate go/no-go decisions, strategic alliances, and key contract vehicles to expedite expansion while maintaining quality

Pipeline strategy

10x pipeline value

- **Example funnel (\$10M target):**
 - \$100M → Identification
 - \$75M → Qualification
 - \$50M → Capture (intel gathering)
 - \$25M → Proposals submitted
 - \$10M → Wins
- **Rationale:** Maintaining a 10x pipeline offsets market attrition, delays, cancellations, and recompute timing shifts





Pipeline strategy

Aligning mission and objectives

- 💡 **Match specialized services to demand:** Align offerings with high-priority agency programs across cybersecurity, cloud, analytics, and modernization initiatives
- 💡 **Budget and forecast insights:** Track DoD Program Objective Memorandum (POM) cycles and civilian transformation budgets for multi-year planning
- 💡 **Annual revenue milestones:** Translate 3–5-year 10x goal into clear annual targets with defined resource requirements and investment timing strategies

Building

Pipeline building

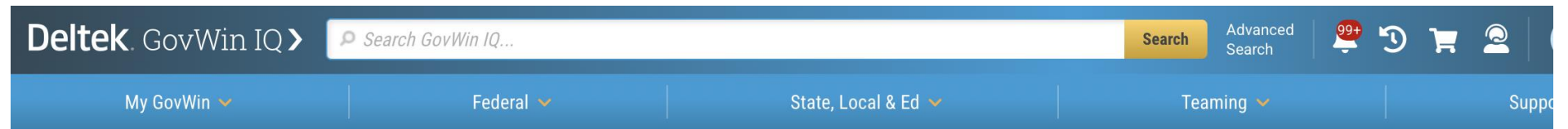
Creating a viable pipeline

- 💛 **Definition:** Represents a structured visualization of contract pursuits across stages from early intel to award
- 💛 **Key components:** Total opportunity value, PWin assessment, timeline tracking, contract type analysis, and set-aside qualification verification
- 💛 **Tools and data sources:** Combine open data (SAM.Gov, FPDS) with subscription platforms (GovWin, GovTribe) and agency relationships
- 💛 **Acquisition elements:** Understand FAR Part 10 (market research), FAR Part 15 (contracting by negotiation), and agency supplements (DFARS, HHSAR, etc.)



A well-defined pipeline aligns BD efforts with operational capacity, helping to prevent resource constraints

Pipeline building



IntelliSearch > Opportunities

[Return to Advanced Search](#) [Load Search](#) [Settings](#) [View Full Screen](#)

Saved Search: "Agency Wide Search"

Selected Filters [Copy](#) [Clear all](#)

Buying Org: Government Type

☒ USA: All Federal Government Types

Opportunity Type

☒ Tracked Opportunities

Status

☒ Forecast Pre-RFP

☒ Pre-RFP

Type of Award

☒ BPA

☒ IDIQ - Agency Specific

☒ IDIQ - MAC

Primary Requirements

☒ IT Services

Solicitation Date

☒ Next 2 Years

Value (USD-\$K)

☒ 500000

Narrow your results

Found 15 results (Showing 1 - 15)

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☒ List View

☐ Grid View

☐ Chart View

Sort by: Value (USD-\$K)

Largest-Smallest

15
Opportunities found

Total value
of Opportunities
found:
\$53 (USD-\$B)

Average value
of Opportunities
found:
\$4 (USD-\$B)

\$ USD
#

☒ Select all

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ADVANCING ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE MULTIPLE AWARD CONTRACT (AAMAC)

10 Doc

Mark: [3](#)

Status: Pre-RFP

Solicitation #: FA800325R0002

Organization: DEFENSE » OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF DEFENSE » CHIEF DIGITAL AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE OFFICE

Opportunity Type: Tracked Opportunities

Opportunity ID: 246431

Solicitation Date: 03/2025 (Government Estimate)

Competition Type: Full and Open / Unrestricted

Type of Award: IDIQ - Agency Specific

Estimated Value: \$15,000,000 (USD-\$K)

Requirement: Information Technology, IT Services

Pipeline building

Pipeline model (example)

GovWin ID	Solicitation ID	Opportunity Name	Buyer Agency	Estimated TCV (\$K)	Release Date	Competition Type	Contract Type	Expected Award(s)
237323	YA132324DTAMRFISS0001	Census Bureau Transformation Application Modernization (CENTAM)	DOC	\$1,000,000	Feb-25	Small Bus Set-Aside	BPA	Multiple - TBD
243324	2024DCCOE005	New Modern Software Development Multiple Award IDIQ	Army	\$10,000,000	Feb-25	Undetermined	IDIQ - Agency Specific	16-20
246431	FA800324R0014	Advancing Artificial Intelligence Multiple Award Contract (AAMAC)	Defense	\$15,000,000	Mar-25	Full and Open / Unrestricted	IDIQ - Agency Specific	Multiple - TBD
244382	W56KGY24RMATOC	Artificial Intelligence and Software at Pace (AIS@P)	Army	\$1,000,000	Mar-25	Undetermined	IDIQ - Agency Specific	Multiple - TBD
249137	75N95025R00017INDUSTRYDAY	HHS One Professional Services Solution (HOPSS)	HHS	\$3,600,714	May-25	Small Bus Set-Aside	IDIQ - Agency Specific	Multiple - TBD
223015	36C10D24Q0038	Veterans Affairs Processing and Automation Services (VPAS)	VA	\$5,400,000	Jun-25	Full and Open / Unrestricted	IDIQ - Agency Specific	Multiple - TBD
231643		Software Engineering Services (SWES 2.0)	DOT	\$548,000	Jun-25	Undetermined	BPA	Multiple - TBD
243861		Scalable Ways to Initiate Flexible Tasks 2 (SWIFT 2)	DHS	\$1,090,000	Nov-25	Partial Small Bus Set-Aside	IDIQ - Agency Specific	Multiple - TBD



Pipeline building

Identifying opportunities

- ✓ **Conduct a gap analysis:** Compare certifications, past performance, and clearances against future contract requirements and competitor capabilities
- ✓ **Go-to-market roadmap:** Establish quarterly submission targets (3–5 major RFPs) with pre-RFP intelligence gathering and industry day participation
- ✓ **Resource planning:** Assign dedicated capture managers to high-value pursuits with allocated budgets for research, marketing, and proposal development



Pipeline building

Early engagement and relationship building

- ✓ **Industry days and conferences:** Gain intelligence on upcoming needs directly from COs and program managers while building brand recognition
- ✓ **Sources sought and RFIs:** Provide detailed responses highlighting your capability to solve agency pain points, strategically influencing final RFP requirements
- ✓ **Teaming and partnerships:** Develop relationships with large primes or small businesses through mentor-protégé programs to expand capabilities and market access

Pipeline building

Opportunity funnel creation

- 👉 **Record all potential opportunities:** Document buyer agency, NAICS codes, estimated values, set-aside status, incumbents, and recompet dates
- 👉 **Elimination criteria:** Apply systematic filtering to remove out-of-scope or underfunded opportunities, focusing resources on viable pursuits
- 👉 **Forecasting demand and timing:** Map cyclical surges (end of fiscal year) and target multi-year IDIQ vehicles for predictable revenue



A broad initial funnel ensures you don't overlook hidden or emerging programs!



Elaboration



Pipeline elaboration

Pre-positioning opportunities

- **Refine opportunity profiles:** Map past performance to anticipated RFP requirements; identify incumbent vulnerabilities and competitive advantages
- **Credibility and visibility:** Develop targeted white papers, case studies, and capabilities presentations demonstrating thought leadership
- **Certifications and partnerships:** Secure or partner for required credentials (CMMC, ISO, CMMI, clearances) ahead of RFP release

Pipeline elaboration

1. **Financial and organizational readiness:** Verify working capital requirements, establish bonding capacity, and prepare for staffing demands
2. **Capture planning and stakeholder mapping:** Document key decision-makers, COs, and technical leads with engagement strategies
3. **Teaming and partnerships:** Structure mentor-protégé or prime/sub relationships to enhance capabilities and strengthen competitive position



A stakeholder map clarifies who influences requirements, funding, and ultimate award decisions

Pipeline elaboration

Prioritizing opportunities (10x focus)

✓ **Weighted scoring model:**

- ✓ Client intimacy (30%), capability fit (30%), RFP timing (20%), and opportunity size (20%)
- ✓ Provides relative scores for opportunity comparison and resource allocation

✓ **Opportunity tiers:**

- ✓ **Tier 1:** Strategic pursuits essential for meeting 10x goals
- ✓ **Tier 2:** Mid-sized engagements building agency presence
- ✓ **Tier 3:** Targeted opportunities filling capability gaps



Tier 1–3 classification ensures high-impact deals get top priority without ignoring valuable mid-tier or niche pursuits

Pipeline elaboration

Strength scoring *(example)*

Opp ID / Solicitation ID / Contract ID	Opportunity or Program Name	Relative Strength Ranking				
		Client Intimacy (30%) Lower = 1 Medium = 3 Higher = 5	Capability Fit (30%) Lower = 1 Medium = 3 Higher = 5	Timing (20%) FY25 = 1 FY26 = 3 FY27 = 5	Opportunity Size (20%) \$5M - \$25M = 1 \$25M - \$50M = 3 >\$50M = 5	Composite Score
234637 / 19AQMM22D0028	ECA EXIT INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY TRANSFORMATION AND OPERATIONS SUPPORT SERVICES 8A SETASIDE	5.00	5.00	5.00	5.00	5.00

Capability mapping *(example)*

P = Primary Service Area; S = Secondary/Supporting Service Area

Opp ID / Solicitation ID / Contract ID	Opportunity or Program Name	Core Capability	Corporate Capability Area(s)					
			Digital Modernization	Cyber	AI and Advanced Analytics	Secure Hybrid and Multi-Cloud	Data Governance	Strategy and Consulting
234637 / 19AQMM22D0028	ECA EXIT INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY TRANSFORMATION AND OPERATIONS SUPPORT SERVICES 8A SETASIDE	Digital Modernization	P	S	S		S	S

Management



Pipeline management

Forecasting and Standardizing Opportunity Data

- **Key data fields:** Track details including name/ID, agency, value, set-aside status, incumbent, contract vehicle, capability alignment, and PWin
- **Quality data:** Invest in relationship-based intelligence gathering beyond basic opportunity details from both primary and subscription sources
- **Tools and validation:** Integrate automated data feeds with manual verification processes using GovWin, SAM.Gov, and agency forecasts
- **Reporting and dashboards:** Provide visibility into pipeline health, resource allocation, and revenue forecasts for executive decision-making

Pipeline management

Managing the pipeline (stage-gate process)

1. **Stage 1: Qualification** – Initial intelligence gathering and sources sought responses
2. **Stage 2: Pursuit** – Go/no-go evaluation and strategic alignment verification
3. **Stage 3: Capture** – Detailed competitive analysis, teaming agreements, and win strategy development
4. **Stage 4: Proposal** – Solution design and comprehensive review process
5. **Stage 5: Award** – Final negotiations and transition planning



Ensure every key opportunity passes a formal gate review, verifying that all required data and quality criteria are met, before committing resources!



Pipeline management

Making go/no-go decisions

Leading reasons to no-bid:

- Near-term RFP release with insufficient preparation time
 - Unable to develop competitive, compliant solution
- Missing critical teammates or qualified personnel
 - Gaps in essential capabilities or past performance
- Insufficient relevant past performance
 - Risk of unfavorable evaluation in source selection
- Limited capture intelligence or customer relationships
 - Inadequate understanding of requirements or competition
- Resource constraints affecting proposal quality
 - Team bandwidth already committed to other pursuits

Bid only when your timeline, team, and track record are aligned

Pipeline management

Go/no-go pitfalls

- Pursuing opportunities based solely on customer suggestions
 - Emotional rather than strategic decision-making
- Limited competitive intelligence
 - Incomplete understanding of win probability factors
- Underestimating proposal investment requirements
 - Insufficient resources for quality submission
- Bypassing formal evaluation process
 - Rushing decisions without proper analysis
- Overextending after initial success
 - Loss of focus and resource dilution

Let data, market insights, and resource alignment drive your pursuit decisions

Pipeline management

Bid criteria

1. **Strategic priority:** Direct alignment with growth objectives
2. **Timing and capture maturity:** Sufficient lead time for positioning
3. **Probability of Win:** Competitive analysis and capability match
4. **OCI concerns:** Impact on future opportunity pipeline
5. **Implementation risk:** Technical and staffing feasibility
6. **Profitability:** Long-term margin sustainability
7. **Strategic intangibles:** Market positioning benefits

Pipeline management

Probability of Win (PWin) criteria

1. **Internal resources:** Dedicated capture and proposal teams
2. **Technical qualifications:** Demonstrated solution capabilities
3. **Client experience:** Relevant past performance portfolio
4. **Ability to staff:** Qualified personnel availability
5. **Competitive positioning:** Differentiated value proposition
6. **Client knowledge:** Deep mission understanding
7. **Price competitiveness:** Market-aligned pricing strategy

Implementation



Pipeline implementation

Continuous improvement and lessons learned

- **Win/loss analysis:** Schedule post-award debriefs, document feedback on technical approach, pricing strategy, and past performance evaluation, and integrate findings into processes
- **Scaling infrastructure:** Implement and optimize pipeline management tools (CRM, capture tracking, proposal automation) and establish data hygiene protocols across opportunity stages
- **Feedback loops:** Hold milestone reviews measuring pursuit quality against standardized criteria, validate resource utilization rates across all active opportunities, and adjust qualification thresholds based on actual win rates and ROI

Pipeline implementation

Key takeaways

1. **Approach:** Align opportunity selection with your growth trajectory, measure agency-specific win themes against incumbent performance, and maintain strict qualification standards
2. **Screening:** Prioritize pursuits where you can demonstrate clear discriminators over incumbent or competitive solutions
3. **Qualifying:** Use weighted scoring criteria across pursuits to drive objective bid decisions and prevent resource dilution on low-probability opportunities



10x growth requires consistent pipeline governance and applying reasoned go/no-go decisioning!

Pipeline implementation

Key takeaways

4. **Teaming:** Build strategic partnerships early in the capture process, focusing on capabilities, past performance, and agency relationships that fill your specific competitive gaps
5. **Management:** Run structured weekly opportunity reviews with defined metrics (active pursuits, PWin adjustments, resource allocation)
6. **Improvement:** Track KPIs including pipeline velocity, conversion rates, bid-to-win ratios, and capture costs



A data-driven pipeline enables you to pivot effectively when key opportunities push to the right!



Pipeline implementation

Putting it into practice

- **Assess:** Compare current pipeline against 10x milestones and capability requirements and validate your resource capacity
- **Refine qualification:** Create standardized go/no-go templates that account for your specific capabilities and gaps
- **Continuously improve:** Hold monthly pipeline velocity reviews measuring conversion rates between stages and conduct quarterly win/loss analysis



Start by mapping existing bids and planned pursuits to confirm alignment with a 10x trajectory

Upcoming Schedule

Government Bid Success Series

- March 27** Part 2: Making Sound Bid Decisions
- April 8** Part 3: Proposal Management Soft Skills
- June 5** Part 4: Writing Past Performance and Resumes in Proposals
- June 26** Part 5: Developing Differentiation
- July 22** Part 6: Developing Agile & Lean Proposal Development
- July 29** Part 7: How Capture and Proposals Differ from GWACs
- August 12** Part 8: Keys to Success with Orals
- October 23** Part 9: Pros and Cons of Proposal AI Tools

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